

Understanding e& and Its ESG Strategy for the Project

Company Overview: What is e&?

e& (Etisalat Group) is a leading technology and telecommunications conglomerate based in Abu Dhabi, UAE. Formerly known as Etisalat Group, e& is the largest telecom corporation in the UAE, providing digital communication services to consumers, businesses, and government entities ¹. In 2022, the company rebranded to “e&” as it embarked on a transformation from a traditional telecom operator into a global technology and investment group ². Today, e& operates across **38 countries** in the Middle East, Asia, Africa, and Europe ³, with multiple business verticals (e.g. **e& international, e& life, e& enterprise, e& capital**) that drive its diversified services. This expansive presence means the company serves a broad stakeholder base and has a substantial impact on various communities and markets.

Mission and Vision: e&'s corporate vision is “to be a leading global technology group,” and its purpose is to “*enrich every day, every moment, for everyone we reach*” ⁴. In practice, this vision translates into leveraging connectivity, digital innovation, and investments to empower customers and societies. e& aims to be at the center of its customers' digital lives, providing not just telecom connectivity but also digital services that make life more productive and enjoyable ⁵. The company's strategy (often referred to as the “e& 2030 strategy”) focuses on several pillars: doubling down on core telecom services, diversifying into new digital verticals, digitalizing internal operations, **and crucially, driving sustainability** as a top priority ⁶.

e&'s ESG Vision and Commitments

ESG (Environmental, Social, Governance) is not an afterthought for e& – it is **central to the company's strategy and identity**. In fact, e& explicitly states that “**ESG is a top priority**”, integrating sustainability into its long-term business goals ⁷ ⁸. As part of its 2030 strategy, e& has made bold public commitments on environmental sustainability. Notably, the group has pledged to achieve **net-zero carbon emissions (Scope 1 and 2)** in its UAE operations by **2030**, and to reach net-zero across the entire group (including Scope 3 emissions) by **2050** ⁷. This ambitious climate goal is to be achieved through a mix of initiatives – such as increasing renewable energy use, energy efficiency, and carbon offset projects – demonstrating e&'s alignment with global climate action efforts (in parallel with the UAE's national Net Zero 2050 strategy).

Beyond carbon targets, e&'s **sustainability vision** encompasses a broad range of ESG objectives: building an **inclusive, diverse workplace**, upholding strong governance and ethical standards, and using its technology for positive social impact. For example, e& strives to foster an **engaged, diverse, and inclusive workforce**, which is evident in its rising female employment (24% of the workforce, the highest ever) and significant local talent development (51% UAE national workforce, a record Emiratisation rate) ⁹. In the social domain, e& emphasizes community well-being – such as supporting education and digital inclusion. One initiative is “*Wider Web*,” a project to improve web accessibility for people with autism ¹⁰, reflecting the company's focus on **digital inclusion** as part of its social responsibility. Another example is e&'s participation in humanitarian campaigns like the “*100 Million Meals*” initiative during Ramadan to fight

hunger ¹¹. These initiatives illustrate how e& integrates social value into its business operations and brand purpose.

On the **environmental** front, e& has demonstrated concrete progress in reducing its footprint. The company reports significant reductions in greenhouse gas emissions and resource usage through operational changes. For instance, by upgrading infrastructure, **indirect emissions (Scope 2)** were **cut by 36%** in one year ¹². e& replaced hundreds of diesel backup generators at cell tower sites with solar-powered solutions, deploying solar energy at **114 sites** ¹³. It also rolled out energy-saving cooling and hybrid power systems at nearly **900 network sites**, saving over *4 million kWh* of electricity ¹⁴. Additionally, e& implemented **100% electronic billing** (eliminating paper bills) to cut waste, reducing paper consumption by 71% ¹⁵. These efforts highlight e&'s strategy of investing in technology upgrades (like fiber optics, solar panels, and digital platforms) to both improve efficiency and reduce environmental impact.

On the **governance** side, e& maintains a strong culture of ethics, transparency, and risk management. The company adheres to principles of **accountability and integrity**, enforced by robust compliance programs. For example, e& has a comprehensive anti-fraud and anti-bribery framework: a confidential whistleblower program encourages employees to report misconduct, and the **"Special Audit"** team investigates any fraud allegations under a **zero-tolerance policy**. This program aligns with ISO 37001 Anti-Bribery standards and underscores that ethical business conduct is non-negotiable at e&. Furthermore, e&'s Audit Committee (a Board subcommittee) provides oversight of financial integrity and compliance – approving ethics & compliance policies and ensuring both internal and external audits are in place to safeguard the company's governance ¹⁶ ¹⁷. In summary, e&'s **ESG vision** is to embed sustainability and ethics into every facet of the business, thereby supporting long-term value creation for both the company and its stakeholders.

How e& Implements ESG Across the Organization

Implementing an ESG strategy at a company as large as e& requires **integrating sustainability practices into all departments and levels** of the organization. e& recognizes that achieving its ESG goals is a **cross-functional effort** – not just the responsibility of a single "sustainability department." The company's approach can be described as a **"hub-and-spoke" ESG governance model** ¹⁸. At the center (hub) is a core Group Sustainability function, led by the Senior Vice President of Sustainability, which sits in e&'s Strategy Department ¹⁹. This central team is responsible for setting the overall sustainability strategy, policies, and targets (aligning with global standards and corporate goals).

From this hub, **ESG responsibility radiates out to all key business units and corporate functions** (the spokes). e& has identified over **50 sustainability champions across the group** – colleagues embedded in different departments and local operating companies – who work together as an **"ESG factory"** of talent to drive initiatives and report progress ²⁰. This cross-functional team meets **monthly to review** sustainability progress against the strategy ²¹. By involving representatives from diverse departments (HR, Finance, Operations, Legal, etc.), e& ensures that each part of the business contributes to and is accountable for the ESG agenda.

Departmental Roles in ESG: Practically every department at e& has a role to play in implementing ESG practices:

- **Group HR (Human Resources):** Focuses on the “Social” pillar – promoting diversity, equity & inclusion, employee well-being, and talent development. For example, HR drives initiatives to increase female leadership, conducts employee engagement surveys (e& achieved a 79% engagement score ²²), and leads health and safety programs (notably e& reported a 0% occupational illness rate for employees, indicating strong HSE practices) ²³. HR also ensures training on ethics and sustainability for staff, building a culture aligned with ESG values.
- **Group Operations and Technology:** Oversee the environmental sustainability in network operations and infrastructure. This includes energy management, emissions reduction, waste reduction, and climate resilience. The **Environmental Sub-Committee** at e& is actually chaired by the Chief Technology Officer, highlighting that technical operations leadership is accountable for environmental performance ²⁴. These teams implement green technologies (like solar power on cell sites, data center efficiency, and network optimizations) and track key metrics like energy usage and carbon footprint. They also handle **innovation for sustainability**, for example using IoT, AI, and cloud solutions to support climate initiatives (e.g. e& co-developing an AI platform for climate disaster resilience) ²⁵.
- **Group Finance:** Integrates ESG into investment decisions, budgeting, and reporting. The finance department works on “**sustainable finance**” aspects such as evaluating capital projects for ESG impact, managing green investments, and ensuring that ESG metrics are included in annual reports. e& aligns its disclosures with international standards (GRI, SASB, etc.) ²⁶ and UAE regulatory guidance (ADX ESG disclosures), which requires Finance and Investor Relations to collaborate on high-quality sustainability reporting. In 2024, e& even conducted its first “**double materiality**” assessment to identify which ESG issues are most financially and environmentally significant ²⁷ – Finance, Strategy, and Risk teams together reviewed these issues to integrate them into the business strategy.
- **Group Legal & Compliance:** Champions the **Governance** pillar – ensuring ethics, compliance, and data privacy. The **Social & Governance Sub-Committee** at e& is chaired by the Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer ²⁸, underlining that the legal department is deeply involved in overseeing ESG matters (like ethical conduct, anti-corruption, human rights policies, and legal compliance with emerging ESG regulations). This department would handle ESG-related policies (e.g. Supplier Code of Conduct, anti-bribery policies, governance charters) and monitor regulatory changes such as new sustainability reporting laws. For instance, with new EU directives like CSRD (Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive) affecting e&’s operations in Europe, the legal/compliance and finance teams are jointly conducting gap analyses to ensure e& meets **international ESG reporting requirements** ²⁹ ³⁰.
- **Group Risk & Internal Audit (Risk & Assurance):** Provides independent oversight and assurance of ESG processes. e&’s internal audit function was rebranded to “**Risk & Assurance**” and is mandated to protect value and empower the organization by evaluating risks (including ESG risks) and controls. This team will audit ESG data and practices to ensure accuracy and compliance. They treat ESG metrics with the same rigor as financial data – for example, starting in 2025 e& will have an **independent third party audit its emissions data** for the first time ³¹. The aim is to provide

external assurance of sustainability data, enhancing its reliability and transparency. Internally, the Risk & Assurance department regularly reviews ESG risk registers (e.g. climate risks, cybersecurity risks, etc.) and reports to the Board's Audit Committee on these matters ³² ³³ .

- **Group Strategy (Sustainability Team):** As mentioned, the central strategy department houses the sustainability team, which orchestrates ESG initiatives group-wide. They set targets (like carbon reduction, social impact goals), track performance on key ESG indicators, and coordinate the **annual sustainability reporting process** (publishing e&s Integrated Report and sustainability reports). They also lead internal capacity-building – in 2024, the sustainability team identified and closed 19 critical gaps across ESG areas to strengthen group-wide performance ³⁴ ³⁵ . Strategy/Sustainability ensures that **each business unit and function has ESG integrated into its plans**, building what e& calls a “*cohesive sustainability framework*” across all operations ³⁶ .
- **Procurement and Admin (Contracts):** Responsible for sustainable supply chain and facilities management. e&s **Admin & Contracts** function (i.e. administrative services and contracting/procurement) is also explicitly listed as part of ESG integration. This department would implement **sustainable procurement** policies – for example, e& gives preference to local suppliers (86% of expenditures are with local suppliers, to support local economies) ³⁷ and evaluates vendors on ESG criteria. They enforce the Supplier Code of Ethics and engage suppliers to uphold labor standards, environmental standards, etc. (In fact, e& has processes to audit suppliers for ESG compliance ³⁸ ³⁹). Admin/Facilities teams also contribute via initiatives like paperless offices (e.g., the 100% e-billing mentioned) and responsible resource use in e&s workplaces.
- **Branding & Communications:** Handles ESG communications, stakeholder engagement, and corporate social responsibility programs. This team ensures that e&s ESG efforts are transparent and well-communicated to investors, customers, and the public. They produce the sustainability reports, press releases on initiatives, and manage community outreach programs (such as charitable campaigns, tech-for-good initiatives, etc.). By effectively communicating progress (for example, showcasing e&s **MSCI ESG rating upgrade to “AA”** – making it the first telecom in the Middle East with that rating ⁴⁰), they help bolster e&s reputation as a sustainability leader. The communications department also educates internal stakeholders on ESG achievements and goals, building pride and buy-in across the company.

In summary, **every department (“vertical”) at e& has ESG responsibilities embedded in its operations** ⁴¹ . This cross-department approach is deliberate: it ensures sustainability is “**embedded across our operations and decision-making**”, with each department contributing to e&s material ESG topics in a unified way ⁴¹ . The company's governance framework provides oversight to keep all these efforts aligned. The **Nomination & Remuneration Committee** of the Board is formally tasked with overseeing ESG matters at the highest level – it reviews progress on sustainability targets and climate action plans, and checks that ESG risks are being managed appropriately ⁴² ³² . Meanwhile, an **Executive Sustainability Steering Committee** (chaired by the Group CEO) convenes top management to drive the execution of sustainability programs and address any challenges in implementation ¹⁸ . This multi-tier governance structure (Board committee, executive committee, sub-committees, and working groups across departments) reflects how seriously e& approaches ESG integration. It's not just about setting lofty goals – it's about **operationalizing those goals** through clear roles, frequent monitoring, and continuous improvement across the organization.

Project Context: Purpose and Scope of the ESG Management System

Given the above, it's clear that e&'s ESG initiatives generate a large volume of data, involve many stakeholders, and must adhere to high standards of accuracy and transparency. The **purpose of the new project** (an ESG management solution to be implemented at e&) is to support and enhance this complex sustainability program using technology. In essence, the system will serve as a centralized platform to **collect, manage, review, and report ESG information** across e&'s departments and business units. By feeding in the background knowledge of e& and its ESG practices, we aim to configure the AI-powered system (e.g. *Claude Code* or another AI agent) to understand the company's context, thereby enabling it to assist with tasks like data analysis, consistency checks, and generating insights or reports aligned with e&'s strategy.

Project Scope and Objectives: The ESG management system will likely cover the following scope:

- **Data Collection:** Capturing ESG performance data from various sources within e&. This includes environmental metrics (energy usage, emissions, waste, water, etc.), social metrics (HR data on diversity, training hours, health & safety incidents, community investment), and governance metrics (code of ethics training completion, audit findings, compliance incidents, etc.). The system must interface with multiple departments – for example, pulling carbon emissions data from Operations' records, HR metrics from the HRIS, and compliance data from the legal team. Ensuring **data accuracy and completeness** is paramount since these metrics feed into public reports and guide strategic decisions ²⁶ ⁴³ .
- **Performance Tracking:** The solution should track progress against e&'s ESG **targets and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)**. For instance, e& has targets like achieving net-zero by 2030 (which can be broken into interim targets like % renewable energy or annual emission reductions), increasing female leadership representation, maintaining zero data breaches, etc. The system will store baseline values and show trends over time, giving **dashboards** or reports that highlight whether each department is on track. This enables early identification of gaps – if a certain business unit's energy consumption is rising, the system should flag it for investigation, supporting a proactive approach to risk management.
- **Alignment with Frameworks:** A crucial objective is to ensure that e&'s ESG data is structured in line with **international reporting frameworks and standards** that the company adheres to. e& has committed to **GRI (Global Reporting Initiative) standards**, SASB (Sustainability Accounting Standards Board), and the **WEF Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics**, among others ²⁶ . It is also preparing for compliance with new regulations like the **EU CSRD**, which mandates detailed sustainability disclosures ²⁹ . Therefore, the system should be built with these frameworks in mind – categorizing data according to ESG topics, making it easy to generate a *GRI Content Index* or a CSRD-aligned report. For example, it might map each data point to relevant GRI indicators or SDG goals, ensuring **nothing important is omitted**. By having a well-structured repository, the company can more efficiently produce its annual Integrated Report and sustainability reports (which e& publishes yearly ⁴⁴ ⁴⁵).

- **Audit Trail and Verification:** Given e&'s emphasis on transparency, the system must maintain a robust **audit trail** for all ESG information. This means every entry or update of data is logged with timestamp and user ID, and supporting evidence (documents, calculations, source references) can be attached. This is important for both internal review and external assurance. e& plans to have third-party auditors verify its sustainability data (for example, verifying the greenhouse gas emissions figures) ³¹. The system should facilitate this by organizing evidence for auditors and perhaps even providing auditor-specific access (read-only) to review data. The goal is to **streamline the assurance process** so that auditors can easily test and confirm the numbers, thereby reinforcing the credibility of e&'s ESG reporting.
- **Workflow and Collaboration:** Implementing ESG practices involves coordinating many contributors. The solution will likely include **workflow features** where different user roles (explained below) can perform their tasks – e.g., department users submit data, reviewers approve or request changes, and auditors sign off. It may send automated reminders to departments when reporting deadlines approach (for quarterly updates or year-end data for the annual report). It could also integrate a **document management** component for qualitative inputs like narratives, policies, and case studies that get included in sustainability reports (for instance, collecting write-ups of ESG initiatives from various country operations). Essentially, the system is a **collaboration platform** that connects all the ESG stakeholders in e&, ensuring everyone follows a standardized process and timeline for sustainability management.
- **Analytics and Insights:** Beyond compliance and reporting, the project likely aims to leverage the AI capabilities (like *Claude*) to derive deeper insights from the ESG data. With all data centralized, the AI agent can analyze patterns and correlations – for example, identifying which energy-saving initiative had the biggest impact on emissions, or forecasting if e& is on course to meet its 2030 targets given current trends. It can also help in **risk analysis** (flagging ESG risks that need attention) and in generating recommendations (e.g., suggesting actions to improve a particular KPI based on industry best practices). Moreover, the AI could assist in drafting report text or answering queries: if a user asks “What was our year-on-year reduction in water usage?” the agent could retrieve and communicate that. By **fully understanding e&'s context and goals**, the AI will be able to provide more relevant and accurate support – whether in automating report writing or providing decision-support to sustainability managers.

In summary, the project's objective is to build an **ESG nerve center** for e&: a system that not only records data, but also enforces the correct processes, ensures data integrity, facilitates audits, and generates insights to drive continuous improvement. This will help e& handle the growing complexity of sustainability management as expectations from regulators, investors, and the public continue to rise.

User Roles in the ESG System

To make this system effective, different types of users will interact with it, each with distinct responsibilities. The prompt specifically mentions three key user roles – **Auditors**, **Reviewers**, and **Admins** – who will use the system. Understanding how each of these users operates in e&'s context is critical for designing an AI

that can assist them appropriately. Below, we describe each role and their involvement in the ESG process at e&:

- **Administrators (Admins):** In the context of this ESG platform, *Admins* are the system overseers and configurators. They are likely part of the central sustainability team or the IT team supporting the project. Admins control user access levels, set up the data input forms or templates for various ESG metrics, and maintain the overall system settings. They are responsible for ensuring the system reflects e&'s reporting structure – for example, configuring the organizational hierarchy (Group level, subsidiary level, department level data), defining the reporting frequency for each metric, and updating any changes in indicators or targets. If new ESG regulations or company targets come in (for instance, if e& introduces a new KPI for water recycling), the Admin would update the system to capture that information. They also manage the **master data** – e.g., lists of GRI codes, SDG mappings, benchmark values – so that everything stays consistent. In essence, Admins **“keep the engine running”**: they handle troubleshooting, ensure data from integrated systems flows correctly, and enforce data quality rules (like units of measure, data validation checks). Given e&'s strong emphasis on controls, Admins may also run periodic checks or scripts (possibly with AI help) to spot anomalies or missing data, then prompt the relevant teams to make corrections. They will be the ones training the AI agent about the data schema and approving any significant actions it takes. Overall, the Admin's priority is to **ensure the system is reliable, secure, and aligned with e&'s evolving ESG requirements**. They may also generate high-level summary reports or dashboards for executive leadership, synthesizing the data once it's been collected and approved.
- **Reviewers:** *Reviewers* are the users who sit in between the data providers (department staff) and the final approval/audit stage. At e&, these would typically be the **sustainability coordinators or managers in each business unit or the Group Sustainability team members** who are responsible for verifying the accuracy and completeness of ESG data submissions. For example, if network engineers provide data on energy consumption, a Reviewer (perhaps an Environmental Manager in the operations department or a Sustainability analyst) will review those entries. Their job is to **check and validate** the data against expectations and evidence. They might compare this month's numbers to last month's, flagging any unusual spikes in emissions or drops in an employee metric, and then query the department for explanation or correction if needed. Reviewers ensure that any required supporting documentation (say, utility bills for energy data, or HR reports for diversity figures) are attached and that the data aligns with defined methodologies (e.g., greenhouse gas calculations follow the set protocol). In e&'s multi-layered structure, there could be multiple levels of reviewers: one at an Operating Company level (e.g., a sustainability lead in e& Egypt might review that subsidiary's data) and another at Group level (the central team that reviews consolidated data from all OpCos). These users play a crucial role in **quality control**. They also track progress on targets – a reviewer will notice if a certain metric is off-track relative to the goal and can raise an alert or initiate an intervention. The system will likely provide them with comparison views, trend analyses, and perhaps AI-driven anomaly detection to assist in their review. By the time the Reviewers mark data as “approved” in the system, it should be accurate and ready for inclusion in official sustainability reports or for auditing. In short, Reviewers act as the **gatekeepers of data integrity**, bridging operational inputs and strategic reporting. They must “speak the language” of both the on-the-ground teams and the reporting requirements, ensuring that what gets recorded in the system is credible and decision-useful.

- **Auditors:** *Auditors* using the system can be of two types – **internal auditors (from e&’s Risk & Assurance department)** or **external independent assurance providers** (such as an audit firm verifying the sustainability report). Both will use the system to extract data and evidence to perform their audits. Internal auditors might periodically assess the ESG data collection process itself – evaluating whether controls are functioning (for example, checking if all required fields were filled, if reviewer approvals are happening on time, etc.), and whether the data in the system matches source documents. They might use system logs to ensure no unauthorized changes were made and that any late modifications have proper justification. External auditors, on the other hand, will focus on validating the **accuracy of the reported metrics** and the adherence to reporting standards. e& has indicated that starting 2025, it will subject its emissions data to independent external verification ⁴⁶. This means auditors will sample entries (e.g. a particular month’s CO₂ emissions) and trace them back to primary evidence (like energy consumption records and emission factor calculations). The system should enable easy retrieval of this evidence – for example, an auditor might download the calculation sheet for Scope 1 emissions or view the attached certificates for renewable energy purchases. The **audit role is critical for maintaining trust**: e& prides itself on transparent, credible reporting ²⁶, and audit findings will help improve any weaknesses. If an auditor finds an inconsistency, they will flag it and the system should allow corrective action (likely by the Admin or Reviewer roles) and an audit note to be recorded. Auditors may also evaluate *process* compliance – confirming that each metric was reviewed by the responsible person and approved, as per the workflow. Since e& operates under robust governance oversight, the Audit Committee will be interested in audit reports from this system. In fact, the presence of audit users in the system underscores e&’s **“trust through transparency”** approach: they are effectively opening up their ESG data and controls for scrutiny to ensure nothing is taken at face value without verification ⁴⁷ ⁴⁸. The AI agent should assist auditors by quickly retrieving information and perhaps even checking consistency across data points (for example, if energy usage increased but emissions stayed flat, is there an explanation like a change to renewable sources?). Ultimately, Auditors using the system will provide the **assurance that e&’s ESG performance is accurately measured and reported**, reinforcing stakeholder confidence.

By delineating these roles – Admin, Reviewer, Auditor – the system (and the AI powering it) can tailor its interface and support to each. **Admins** might get more technical tools and configuration options, **Reviewers** get analytical and comparison tools, and **Auditors** get read-only access with emphasis on traceability and reporting. All actions and handoffs between these roles should be clearly defined (for instance, data might not be “final” until reviewed and then audited). This hierarchy of checks mirrors e&’s own governance philosophy where multiple layers ensure reliability. For example, e&’s sustainability data passes from data owners to a Sustainability Committee review to Board oversight ⁴²; similarly, in the system, data moves from entry to reviewer approval to auditor sign-off.

Key Considerations for the AI Agent (“Claude Code”)

Equipping an AI agent with this comprehensive understanding of e& and its ESG management approach will enable it to function as an **“intelligent assistant”** within the system. The AI needs to grasp not only the data points, but also the context – *why* certain data is important, *who* cares about it, and *what* the end goals are. With the information compiled above, the agent should appreciate the following:

- **The Strategic Importance of ESG:** e& considers ESG outcomes as core to its success, not peripheral. Therefore, any recommendations or actions the AI suggests must align with improving ESG

performance and not simply cost or efficiency in isolation. For instance, if optimizing a process, the AI should not propose something that saves time but undermines data quality or stakeholder trust. The agent knows that **accuracy and transparency are paramount** (it has seen e& explicitly committed to rigorous reporting standards ²⁶).

- **Holistic, Department-Spanning View:** The AI is aware that sustainability is a shared responsibility. So, if asked a question or tasked with an analysis, it can draw information from across departments. Example: if analyzing carbon reduction potential, it might involve data from Operations (energy), Procurement (supplier emissions), and HR (employee engagement in green initiatives). It will avoid siloed answers. It can also anticipate that a change in one area (like a new travel policy by HR to reduce flights) could affect data in another (lower Scope 3 emissions in Operations). This systems thinking makes the AI's outputs more insightful for e&'s needs.
- **Role-Specific Responses:** When interacting with users, the AI should modulate its assistance based on role. An *Admin* might ask the AI to help configure a new indicator – the AI should then recall standards (maybe suggest aligning it with a GRI code) or troubleshoot a data import. A *Reviewer* might ask “find anomalies in this quarter’s data” – the AI can use its knowledge to highlight departments that deviate from trends or any material topic that isn't meeting targets. If an *Auditor* queries a number, the AI should provide the source and evidence trail (since auditors care about proof). Essentially, understanding e&'s context allows the AI to produce **relevant, context-aware answers** rather than generic ones.
- **Adherence to Procedure:** The AI should reinforce “the way things must be handled.” This means following e&'s workflow: data should go through review before considered final, any critical change should trigger an approval or re-check, etc. If, for example, someone tries to mark data as final without reviewer approval, the AI (as a smart guardian) might warn or prevent it, because it knows e& values that review step for quality control. If a user asks the AI to summarize the ESG performance, it will know to use only *approved* data in its summary, not preliminary figures. The AI can also remind users of deadlines (e.g., “The Q3 data submission window closes tomorrow”) because timely reporting is part of how things are handled in such systems.
- **Continuous Learning and Improvement:** With the project's data, the AI can identify areas for improvement over time. For instance, it might notice that one particular metric often gets sent back by reviewers for corrections – highlighting a need for better guidance or training in that area. It could then suggest to Admins to clarify definitions or to provide targeted help to that department. Since e& fosters a culture of continuous improvement in ESG (recall that they found and fixed 19 ESG process gaps in 18 months ⁴⁹), the AI should also operate in that spirit – using each cycle of reporting to get smarter and help users avoid past mistakes.

By compiling all of this information, we ensure the AI agent has a **comprehensive understanding of e&'s business, ESG strategy, and internal workflows**. The agent is now contextually enriched: it knows who e& is, what sustainability means to the company, what goals are being pursued, and how the internal process and user roles are structured to achieve those goals. This foundation will enable the AI to function effectively as an “agentic” assistant – one that can proactively support the ESG management solution, make informed suggestions, and interact knowledgeably with e& stakeholders. Ultimately, the success of this project will be measured by how well the technology (including the AI) helps e& meet its ESG objectives: driving positive environmental and social impact while upholding top-tier governance and transparency

standards 50 51 . With the combined human and AI efforts under this well-defined framework, e& is better positioned to achieve its sustainability ambition of being a **sustainable market leader** that “**champions the ambitions of its business and stakeholders**” 50 .

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